

I grew up in Chamba, a small town in the hills of Himachal Pradesh. The buildings around me were modest which are built for the environment, built for the people living in them, nothing more. There was no luxury, but there was honesty.

MAN TO SEE

*Design for
the person
inside*

When I first saw images of grand, carefully designed buildings and interiors which have beautiful spaces with considered materials, dramatic light, and a real sense of atmosphere. There I felt something I could not explain at the time. Not just admiration, but a kind of pull. I knew, even before I understood what architecture was, that I wanted to make spaces like that. Spaces that feel extraordinary to be inside.

That desire has never left me. I am drawn to design that is beautiful, luxurious, and aesthetic. As I have studied architecture and worked on real design projects, I have come to understand something that I believe is one of the most important problems facing contemporary design practice today.

Contemporary design treats beauty and comfort as a choice and we can have one, but rarely both

Contemporary design has created a false separation between aesthetics and comfort. Beautiful spaces are treated as spaces you admire. Comfortable spaces are treated as spaces that are too ordinary to be exciting. The assumption that a space cannot be both, truly beautiful and genuinely comfortable to live in which is not true, and it is producing architecture and interiors that fail the people who use them.

This is not a small problem. When comfort becomes secondary to appearance, people pay the price. A space that looks beautiful but is uncomfortable or impractical to live in is not successful design and it becomes a design that has forgotten its purpose.

The issue goes beyond individual projects. Contemporary design culture often treats comfort and livability as ordinary, while celebrating visual drama and aesthetic boldness as the true markers of good design. As a result, spaces are increasingly designed to impress visually rather than to genuinely support the people living in them.

How I intend to address this through my future design practice

My intention as a designer is to refuse this false choice entirely. I want to make spaces that are genuinely beautiful spaces with considered materials, real atmosphere, and aesthetic ambition and that are at the same time genuinely comfortable and liveable for the inhabitants. I do not see these as competing goals. I see them as the same goal, and I believe that achieving both at once is the real challenge and the real standard of good design.

My Stuff and Space project in third semester shaped this understanding directly. Designing a multigenerational house for sixteen family members forced me to think about atmosphere and functionality at the same time. Every decision had to balance beauty with the practical realities of daily living. Generous shared spaces prevented overcrowding, while the bedroom arrangements gave each person a sense of place within the house. The project made me realise that beauty and function are not opposing goals but they depend on each other.

My Light and Sound project reinforced the same idea through lighting. Light creates atmosphere and visual character, but it also determines how comfortable a space feels to use. A lighting design that is visually striking but uncomfortable fails just as much as one that is functional but lifeless. The challenge lies in achieving both together.

In my future practice, I want to hold beauty and livability to the same standard. Using digital tools such as modelling, rendering, and visualization, I aim to design spaces that are aesthetically ambitious while remaining deeply responsive to the people living in them. I do not believe comfort and beauty should exist separately as meaningful design must achieve both at once.

01

Both, always

Every project must meet two standards: genuine aesthetic quality and genuine comfort for the person living in the space. Neither can substitute for the other.

03

Comfort is not ordinary

Making a space genuinely comfortable to live in is one of the hardest design problems there is. It deserves as much ambition and attention as any aesthetic goal.

02

Beauty is not decoration

Real beauty in architecture comes from spaces that are well-proportioned and well-suited to the people using them not from visual drama applied on top of a design.

04

Design for the person inside

The measure of a successful space is how the person living in it feels and not how it looks in a photograph or on a presentation board.

I came to architecture because spaces moved me because I felt, even as a child looking at buildings I had never been inside, that they had the power to affect how people live and feel. I still believe that. What I want to add to that belief, through my practice, is the conviction that a space does not have to sacrifice beauty for comfort, or comfort for beauty. Both are possible. Both are necessary. And delivering both, every time, is the standard I intend to hold myself to.